7. The largest number of Buddhists is found in

(a) Bihar (b) Karnataka
(c) Maharashtra (d) Uttar Pradesh

Ans. (c) : The largest concentration of Buddhism is in Maharashtra (58.3%), where (73.4%) of the total Buddhists in India reside. Karnataka (3.9 lakh) ,Uttar Pradesh (3.0 lakh), West Bengal (2.4 lakh) and Madhya Pradesh (2.0 lakh) are other states having large Buddhist population Sikkim (28.1%), Arunachal Pradesh (13.0%) and Mizoram (7.9%) have emerged as top three states in terms of having maximum percentage of Buddhist population.

8. Assertion (A) : Harshavardhana convened the Prayag Assembly.

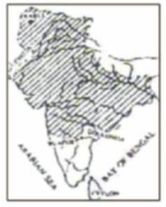
Reason (R) : He wanted to popularise only the Mahayana form of Buddhism.

(a) Both A and R are individually true and R is the correct explanation of A
(b) Both A and R are individually true but R is NOT the correct explanation of A
(c) A is true but R is false
(d) A is false but R is true

Ans. (b) : Harshavardhana convened the Prayag Assembly to popularise himself among his people. He wanted to popularise Mahayana form of Buddhism in influence of Hiuen-Tsang and he called a conference in Kannauj for that.

MEDIEVAL HISTORY

9. The shaded area in the above map shows the empire of:



(a) Ala-ud-din Khalji
(b) Mohammed Tughlaq
(c) Shahjahan
(d) Aurangzeb

Ans. (c) : Shah Jahan assumed the Mughal throne on 24 January 1628 in Agra, a few days after the death of Jahangir. He inherited a vast and rich empire; and at mid-century this was perhaps the greatest empire in the world, exhibiting a degree of centralized control rarely matched before. Shah Jahan expanded his empire in all directions: he annexed the Rajput kingdoms of Baglana and Bundelkhand to the west, and in 1635 he captured the kingdoms of Bijapur and Golconda in the Deccan.

10. The Mongols under Chengiz Khan invaded India during the reign of

(a) Balban
(b) Feroz Tughlaq
(c) Iltutmish
(d) Muhammad bin Tughlaq

Ans. (c) : Mongols under Chengiz Khan (died in 1227) invaded India during the reign of Iltutmish (1211-36) but did not enter deep in India as Iltutmish refused to give shelter to the Persian king, Khwarizm Shah, whom Chengiz Khan was chasing.

11. Which of the following pairs is correctly matched?

(a) Dewan-i-Bandagan : Tughlaq
(b) Dewan-i-Mustakhraj : Balban
(c) Dewan-i-Kohi : Alauddin Khilji
(d) Dewan-i-Arz : Muhammad Tughlaq

Ans. (a) : Diwan-i-Bandagani was a department created by Feroz Shah Tughlaq. It was a department made for slaves. It was important because at that time Delhi had a lot of slaves. Diwan-i-Bandagan had the responsibility to take care of them.

12. In which one of the following cities is the Lingaraja Temple located?

(a) Bhubaneswar (b) Bijapur
(c) Kolkata (d) Shravanabelagola

Ans. (a) : Lingaraj is temple dedicated to Harihara, a form of Shiva and Vishnu. It is a 10 century temple surrounded by high walls and is also called Harihara temple. The temple is believed to be built by the kings from the Somavamsi dynasty. It is situated in Bhubaneswar, Odisha.

13. Assertion (A) : The Battle of Khanwa was certainly more decisive and significant than the First Battle of Panipat.

Reason (R) : Rana Sanga, the Rajput hero, was certainly a more formidable adversary than Ibrahim Lodi.

(a) Both A and R are individually true and R is the correct explanation of A
(b) Both A and R are individually true but R is NOT the correct explanation of A
(c) A is true but R is false
(d) A is false but R is true

Ans. (a) : The Mughal dynasty in India was established after Babur defeated Ibrahim Lodi in the first battle of Panipat in 1526 AD. But the erstwhile Rajput kingdom was still undivided. One ruler of this undivided kingdom was Rana Sanga. It invited Babur to India with the aim that he would go back after defeating Ibraham Lodi like other Muslim invaders but it did not happen.

In 1527 AD, there was a Khanwa war between Babur and Rana Sanga, in which Rana Sanga was defeated. Thus after this the Mughal Empire actually began to expand.

MODERN HISTORY

14. Who among the following Indian rulers established embassies in foreign countries on modern lines?

(a) Haider Ali (b) Mir Qasim
(c) Shah Alam II (d) Tipu Sultan

Ans. (d) : Tipu Sultan established embassies in France, Turkey and Egypt on modern lines. Tipu Sultan, is known for his valiant acts in several wars and the sacrifices he made to save his land from foreign invaders. He is remembered for saving Deccan India from the British for a long period of time. He was the ruler of the Kingdom of Mysore from 1782 to 1799.

15. The Hunter Commission was appointed after the

(a) Black-hole incident
(b) Jalianwala Bagh massacre
(c) Uprising of 1857
(d) Partition of Bengal

Ans. (b) : Hunter Commission was appointed after the Jallianwala Bagh Massacre (13 April 1919). A separate Hunter Commission (1882-83) emphsised on primary and secondary education.

16. Under the Permanent Settlement, 1793, the Zamindars were required to issues pattas to the farmers which were not issues by many of the Zamindars. The reason was

(a) The Zamindars were trusted by the farmers
(b) There was no official check upon the Zamindars
(c) It was the responsibility of the British government
(d) The farmers were not interested in getting pattas

Ans. (b) : John Shore planned Permanent Settlement and it was introduced in 1793 by Lord Cornwallis. Zamindars were made the owners of the land and the British got a fixed share of $10/11^{th}$ of the revenue collected by the zamindars.
There was no official checkup on the Zamindars so they did not issued pattas to farmers.

17. Consider the following statements:

1. Arya Samaj was founded in 1835.
2. Lala Lajpat Rai opposed the appeal of Arya Samaj to the authority of Vedas in support of its social reform programmes.
3. Under Keshab Chandra Sen, the Brahmo Samaj campaigned for women's education.
4. Vinoba Bhave founded the Sarvodaya Samaj to work among refugees. Which of these statements are correct?

Which of these statements are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 and 3
(c) 2 and 4 (d) 3 and 4

Ans. (d) : Arya Samaj was founded in 1875 by Swami Dayanand Saraswati in Bombay. Dayanand Saraswati is called the 'Martin Luther' of India. Lala Lajpat Rai was also a famous Arya Samaji.

The Brahmo Samaj was founded by Raja Rammohan Roy in 1828 AD. After them, Devendranath Tagore and Keshav Chandra Sen carried forward this movement. Keshav Chandra Sen launched a movement for women's education. Vinoba Bhave founded Sarvodaya Samaj to work among refugees.

18. Who among the following leaders proposed to adopt Complete Independence as the goal of the Congress in the Ahmedabad session of 1920?

(a) Abdul Kalam Azad
(b) Hasrat Mohani
(c) Jawahar Lal Nehru
(d) Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi

Ans. (b) : The Swadeshi movement started after the Partition of Bengal in 1905. After this the concept of Swarajya began to take a wide form. But the complete self-rule was still in the form of imagination. In the 1920 Ahmedabad Congress Session, Hasrat Mohani proposed to make the Swarajya the goal of the Congress for the first time, but this proposal was unsuccessful. Lahore session of 1929 (which was presided over by Pt. Jawaharlal Nehru) passed the proposal of complete self-government.

19. Who among the following organized the famous Chittagong armoury raid?

(a) Laxmi Sehgal (b) Surya Sen
(c) Batukeshwar Datta (d) J.M. Sengupta

Ans. (b) : The Chittagong armoury raid was an attempt on 18th April, 1930, to hold the armoury of police and auxiliary forces from the Chittagong armoury in the Bengal presidency. It was organised by Surya Sen and his followers.

20. A London branch of the All India Muslim League was established in 1908 under the presidency of:

(a) Aga Khan (b) Ameer Ali
(c) Liaquat Ali Khan (d) M.A. Jinnah

Ans. (b) : In 1908, a branch of the Muslim League was established in London under the chairmanship of Ameer Ali.

21. Who among the following, was the President of the All-India States Peoples Conference in 1939?